

E1iz@b3ths_D1g1t@_N0t3b00k_Intro_ Class

My initial feelings coming into class:

- I chose this class because it presented the opportunity to learn something completely outside of my wheelhouse!
 - I typically select classes that are well-aligned with my pre-existing skillset; my chaotic Summer completing an Ingenium practicum where all of our plans had to change on a dime showed me that sometimes we can learn more from doing something that involves a lot of managing uncertainty and failure than we can from doing the things that come to us somewhat easily.
- After we discussed how we connect to this material, I remembered that I used to copy and paste code into my Tumblr blog to change the appearance and layout. Perhaps I'm not as inexperienced as I thought!

Class Notes

- Digital histories is a way of connecting with audiences and building communities across boundaries of place/time; allows you to find your "people" for your project
- Allows us to explore "what ifs" that we otherwise can't test
 - Fex: Agent-based modelling can be a tool of necromancy
 - giving models a set of behaviours according to a given set of cultural/social/historical norms, including individual-based characteristics in wide swaths
 - Idea a heterogenous set of agents will interact and something real will emerge out of it - if rules based on roman social customs, than what you produce has something to do with roman social customs
 - for example, can change economic conditions to see how people respond
- The process of learning in coding is just as much about the ways things break as what goes right... your practice is about a willingness to be vulnerable about your process, make mistakes
 - harder to do this when your identities/presentations are the subject of internet vitriol.
-how can we reframe our mistakes?
- Digital history as a way of connecting not just with the past, but with places humans have no business being, about access
- Digital humanities, like most subjects, has had its own turns/waves.
 - In 70s, criticized for turning people into numbers (too qualitative)
 - In 90s, web emerges and creates new possibilities
 - the valley in the shadow of death

- "Name of the Rose" digital library with rooms that correspond with geographic relationships
- In 2000s, phrase "digital humanities" is coined
 - about examining not only how we affect digitizing, but how it affects us back!
 - spreadsheets, for example, reveal so much about us and our choices. Our digital approach = our methodology
 - Look at acts of transformation, not just final product
- FAIL GLORIOUSLY !!!!!
 - Paradata is your embarrassing, real story of progress
 - Can work in community rather than as a heroic, lonely individual.
 - Look at reviews in DH as a resource
- And relation between data/things is a network. What is missing can also tell you just as much

Our goal: avoid dead research and learn coding as a matter of literacy!

My main take-aways:

- about the process of learning, revelations as we TRY
- the opportunity to learn in a safe environment where you won't get ripped apart for being a woman trying something online
- choices in digital history can be more revealing than final product and stated intentions